

DEVELOPING MECHANISM FOR DEALING WITH SLOW AND FAST LEARNER

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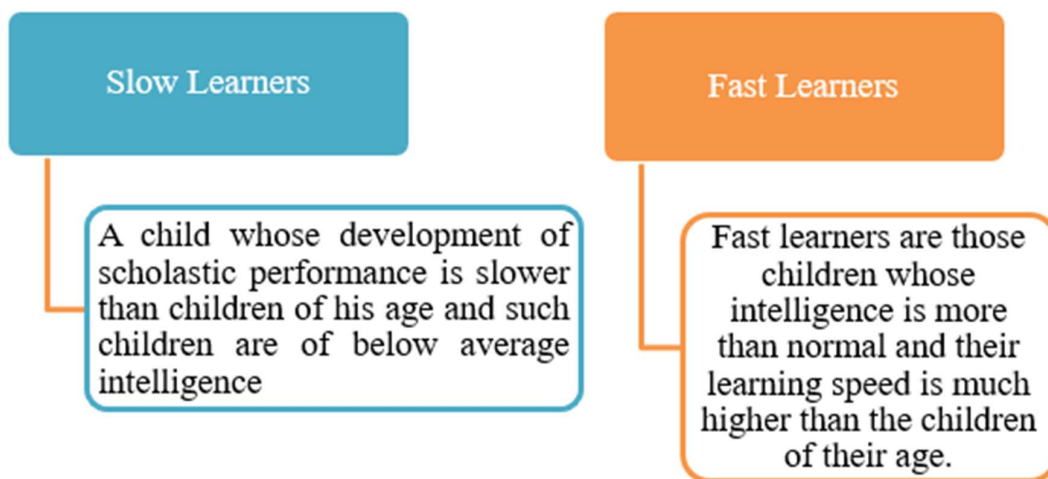
Preliminary Considerations

When a teacher is teaching in his/her classroom, he/she observes different types of behavior such as which child is attentive and who is not, who is active during teaching and learning and who is not, who answers questions. Who asks questions and who doesn't. Therefore, there are different types of students in a class which is the result of their individual differences. Every student is different in his interests, abilities, skills, achievements, etc.

For all these reasons, each child's response to classroom activities is different. There are some children in the class who actively participate in classroom and co-curricular activities and learn at a fast pace, while on the other hand there are some children who have low activity and are unable to learn at a fast pace. Keeping all these variations in mind, the teacher tries to create his teaching-learning environment so that maximum development of all the students of the class can be ensured.

Let us get the basic information about slow learners and Fast Learners before proceeding further.

Flow Chart No – 01



al Elaboration of the Terms

Need, Justification and Rationale

India is a multi-lingual and multi-cultural country and the reflection of the culture and civilization of any country is visible in the schools. In the words of John Dewey, 'School is a miniature form of society', it means that if you want to understand the basic nature of any society, then you should go to the school of that society. Innumerable students studying in Indian schools come from different types of backgrounds. Here you will find students of different languages, ethics, values, beliefs, religion, culture and civilization under one roof. Just as all these students differ in their culture, language, faith, religion, etc., similarly they differ from each other in their cognitive abilities, this is known as individual differences. Even emotions are not the same in forms, there is substantial variation in these. Individual differences have a wide impact on the teaching-learning process, which we can understand through the following Cases –

Table No – 01
Classroom Observations with Supporting Studies

Sl. No.	Case No with Description	Classroom Observation	Supporting Studies
1.	Case No – 1: Learning Mathematical Concepts	Kamlesh teaches Mathematics to Class VIII students while teaching one day he observes all his students and infers from body language that some students are finding it difficult to understand the concepts taught by him. Some of the students are solving concept-based problems with ease. He observed that Ravi responded slowly with respect to mathematical problems while Sandesh solved the same problem quickly and showed it to him. This reflects that Ravi and Sandesh has a difference in mathematical aptitude where Ravi is slow to learn mathematical concepts while Sandesh is quick to solve mathematical problems.	(Wang, 1983)
2.	Case No – 2: Lack of Social Cohesiveness	Sita and Sarita are good friends. Sita does not understand some concepts in maths and English, on the other hand, Sarita does not have any subject matter problems, she understands mathematical concepts quickly and reacts quickly. The teacher categorizes slow learners and fast learners and separates the classes of both. Such categorization is nothing less than a mental trauma for them.	(Sheeja S Varghese, 2021)
3.	Case No – 3: Language Learning and Terminological Elaborations	Dr. Shraddha is the class teacher of Class XII of English Grammar. In this class Sunita is very good in speaking English and pronunciation of English words as well. On the other hand Vinita finds difficulty for pronouncing lengthy English words. She also finds difficulty in spell the words.	(Zakarneh et al., 2020), (Yulian et al., 2022), (Pham et al., 2021)

Keeping in mind these cases it infers that the teacher has to ensure individual attention to individual differences otherwise inclusive development cannot be achieved (Wang, 1983). Now the question arises that such students who are slow learners, should we have to arrange a different teaching-learning system

and if we do so, are we not violating the concept of inclusion? One such research was done. In which it was found that slow learners and fast learners do not want separate classes from each other because by doing so they find that there is a lack of unity, sociability, gentleness, it also results that the concept of inclusive education is not reflected on the ground of reality, which is currently a global concern (Sheeja S Varghese, 2021). It has been found in most of the researches that this kind of difference is often reflected in understanding the facts, concepts and concepts of most languages, mathematics and science (Zakarneh et al., 2020), (Yulian et al., 2022), (Pham et al., 2021).

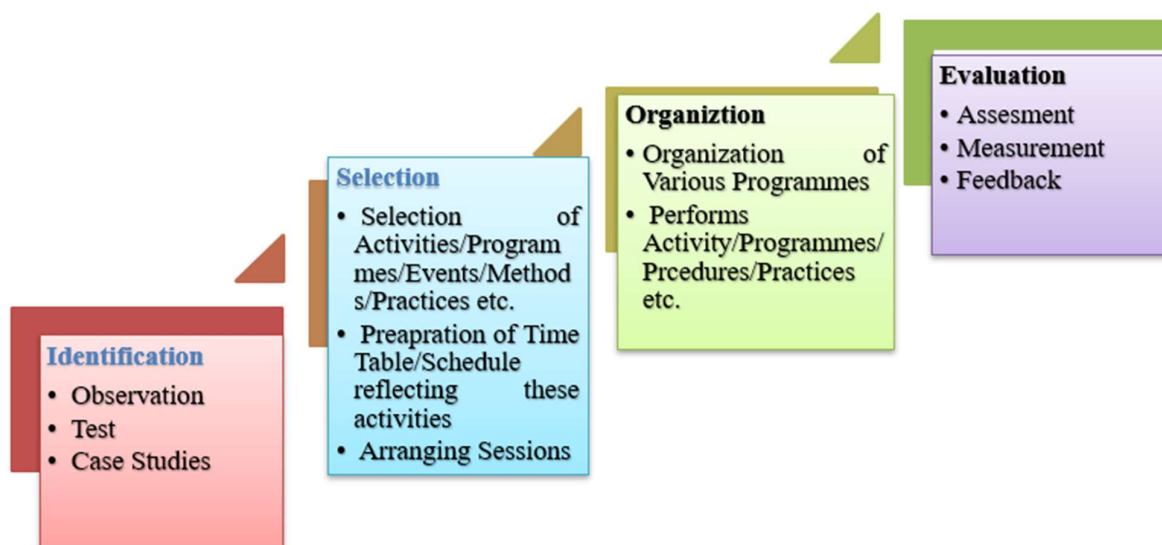
Therefore, keeping in mind the slow learners and fast learners and to implement the concept of inclusive education on the ground of reality, it becomes very necessary that without any separation, we bring the children of our class into the mainstream, therefore the present study is very original, meaningful, important and relevant because in this study a mechanism has been developed to maximize the abilities of the slow learner and fast learner of the class.

Mechanism for Dealing with Slow and Fast Learner

There are three step procedural mechanism i.e., ISOE, for Slow and Fast Learners, which is reflected in the given following-

Flow Chart – 02

Steps in Mechanism for Dealing with Slow and Fast Learners



Major Approaches for dealing with Slow and Fast Learners

There are some very important approaches identified and elaborated by the researcher for dealing with slow and fast learners before discussing mechanism for dealing with slow and fast learners.

Table No – 02

Major Approaches

Sl. No.	Approaches	Expansion	Explanation
1.	IAS	Individual Assistance and Support	This approach is basically used for both the learners i.e., slow and Fast Learners. Teacher understands the abilities of the students and give individual assistance and support like

			guidance and counselling, problem solving, task and projects for their personal development.
2.	TEAM	Tutorial for Efficiency, Attainment and Motivation	Team approach is very useful for slow learners for enhancing efficiency, attainment and motivation level by organizing various activities i.e., games and sports activities, group task or presentation, personalized motivational lectures.
3.	R & D	Remedial and Diagnostic Teaching	R & D is dedicated for identifying weak areas of students and organizing teaching learning experience accordingly. It is very useful for slow learners.
4.	CARE	Creativity Advancement Route Exercise	Care approach is very useful for both the learners. It promotes creativity skills of students by organizing various activities/exercise i.e., essay writing, blind painting, expressive and creative writings, problem and task-based exercises.
5.	IdEA	Identification of Efficiency and Attainment	Each and every student of the class in terms of their abilities due to individual differences. Therefore, it is very important to identify the efficiency and attainment level of the students. It can be identified by using observation, tests, interview, talk etc.
6.	PUSH	Progressive and Useful Stimulus Harvesting	In this approach teachers apply stimulus – response activity because it generates curiosity in children which is very important for effective learning. _
7.	CUTE	Communicable and Useful Teaching Experience	Teaching should never be one way. It should always be interactive so that children can openly solve their questions and doubts. Due to this the students take interest in the class and their attainment also increases.
8.	CAI	Computer Added Instructions	A Teacher should use Computer Based Instructions (CBI) and other related gadgets for making lesson plan more engaging, interesting and interacting by applying linear and branching techniques of Programmed Instruction.
9.	UPSC	Unified Preparation for Social Contribution	This approach is very useful for developing social abilities in slow and Fast Learners, promotes social acceptance and cohesiveness among themselves, and prepare for social contribution. An institution should organize various activities of social concern like; Girl Education Awareness Programme, Health Awareness Programme, Vaccination Drive etc.
10.	EARN	Enrichment & Acceleration Resource Network	Universities and Higher Education Institutions (HEIs) have a very vast resource network i.e., Laboratories, Excursion Facilities, Field Exercise Network etc. for enrichment and acceleration for Slow Learners and Slow Learners.
11.	'3A'	Assessment-Activity-Assessment	Higher Education Institutions (HEIs) and Universities should apply 3'A' formula; assessment through classroom observation such as sessional tests, annuals test etc. for organizing their

			various activities accordingly and then assessment for checking attainment level.		
12.	'3P'	Plan-Process-Product	Plan: An Academic calendar should be prepared including all the activities such as curricular and co-curricular activities for enriching students' experiences	Process: Organization of various activities which is planned in academic calendar at department and university level as well	Product: Effective planning and process ensures quality of a product and this quality provides social and professional identity
13.	'3E'	Engage-Explore-Elaborate	Engage: Engaging Fast Learners for the optimum utilizations of their capabilities by organizing seminar, debate, extempore activities	Explore: Teachers provides a free and creative environment for exploring various ideas, concepts, theories and discoveries etc.	Elaborate: An elaborative student is able to express his/her thoughts, ideas, concepts and curiosities before the teachers, which is very useful for organizing Activities/ Exercises.

Step – I

Identification of Slow and Fast Learners

As mentioned in flow chart number 1, there are three major techniques for identifying the slow and fast learners-

- Observation: By using this technique, a faculty observes behaviour very deeply so that he/she is able to identify behavioural activeness or inactiveness of a child.
- Test: A faculty applies performance tests, diagnostic tests, intelligence test for identification purpose.
- Case Studies: There are many factors affecting the behavior of a student like social factors, educational factors, economic factors, cultural factors etc. An in-depth understanding of all these factors is very important for a teacher for proper guidance and counseling. A Mentor-Mentee system is also

useful for organizing personalized guidance and counseling programmes.

An example of list of slow and fast learners has been given in following table with their basis-

Table No – 03

Identification of Slow and Fast Learners with their respective Basis

Sl. No.	Base (s) of Identification	Imaginary Name of the Students	Programme
Fast Learners			
1.	Achievement, Performance and Observation	Sunil Kumar Prajapati	M.A,
2.		Preeti Kumari	M.A..
Slow Learners			
4.	Diagnostic and Performance Test	Rajesh Kumar Yadav	M.A..
5.		Jyoti Mishra	M.A.

Step –

Time-Table/Schedule for Arranging Various Selected Activities

After the Identification of students by using various methods, a Time-Table or Schedule should be prepared by the faculty member for mentoring the slow and fast learners. In given table, there are some very important arrangements are reflected for engaging the slow and fast learners.

Table No – 04

Time-Table/Schedule for Arranging Various Selected Activities

Sl. No.	Days	Imaginary Name of the Students	Area of Concern	Specific Area	Activities/ Exercise/Sessions	Imaginary Allotted Mentor	Time
M.A Course							
Fast Learner							

1.	Every Saturday	Sunil Kumar Prajapati	Creativity Enhancement	Psychological & Educational	Expert Lecture, Performance and Task Orientation, Brainstorming	Dr. Kripal Singh	03:00pm – 04:00pm
2.		Preeti Kumari	Expression and Elaboration	Educational and General	3‘D’ Formula Discussion, Debate, Discourse	Dr. Vinita Shah	03:00pm – 04:00pm
Slow Learner							
3.	Every Saturday	Rajesh Kumar Yadav	Experimental Designs	Educational	Individual Assistance and Problem-Solving Session	Dr. Shyam Singh	04:00pm - 05:00pm
4.		Jyoti Mishra	Learning Theories	Psychological & Educational	Tutorials, Remedial Teaching	Dr. Taran Ahuja	04:00pm - 05:00pm

Step – III

Organization of Various Special Programmes

After the Identification of Slow and Fast Learners (Step – I) and Selection and Arrangement of various Activities/Programmes (Step – II) now its time to organize various special programmes for nourishing and flourishing the talent and capabilities of Slow and Fast Learners.

The following table no 5, reflects major special programmes may be conducted or performed by different distinguish Universities and Higher Education Institutions (HEIs).

Table No – 05
List of Various Special Programmes

Sl. No.	Activities/Special Program		
	Slow Learners	Common	Fast Learners
1.	Diagnostic Test & Remedial Teaching	Seminars	Creativity Enrichment & Enhancement Session
2.	Individual Assistance	Conferences	Brainstorming Session

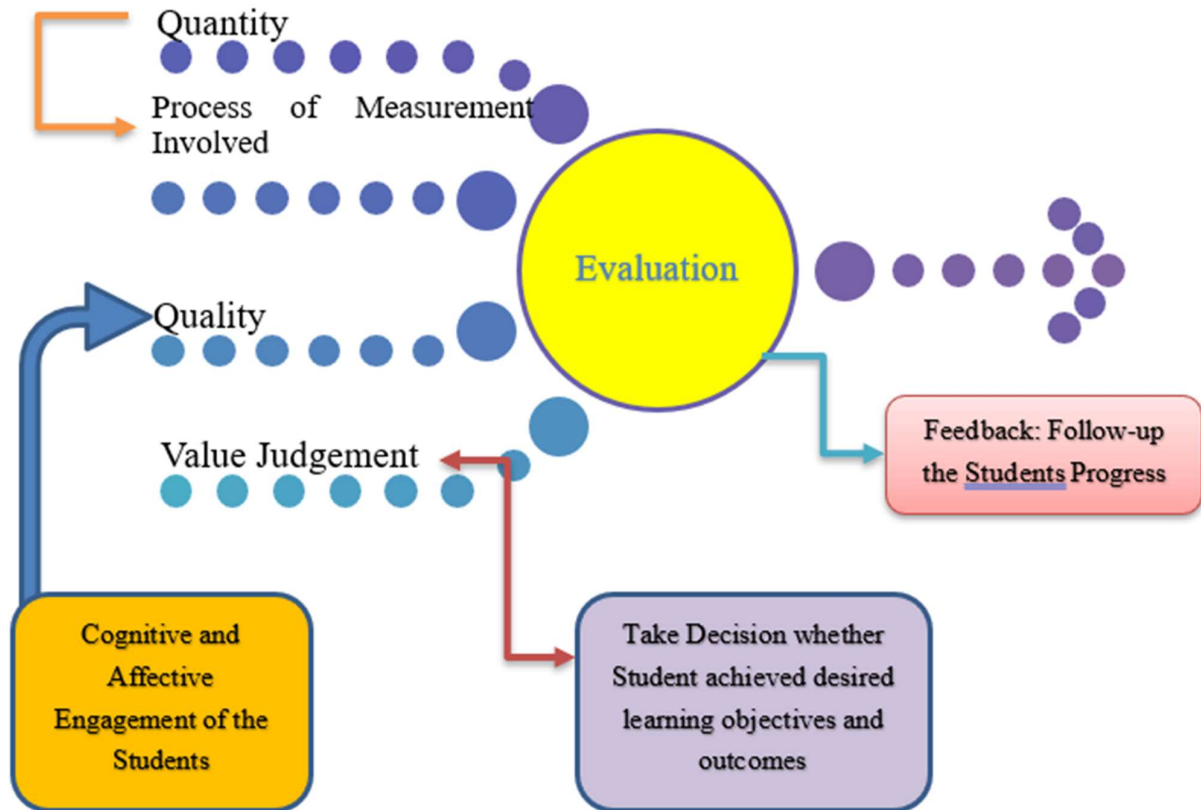
3.	Computer Based Learning	Workshops	Expert Lecture & Guidance
4.	Use of Audio-Video and Interactive Methods	Symposium	3 'D' Formula Debate, Discussion and Discourse
5.	Tutorials & Peer Tutoring	Community Outreach Programmes	3 'E' Formula Engage, Elaborate, Explain
6.	Communication Skills Development Session	Cultural and Social Activities	Games & Sports
7.	Guidance & Counselling Session	Peer Interaction & Communication	Mentoring

Step – IV

Evaluation

Before elaborating this step, let us know about the term evaluation mathematically in the following Flow Chart No – 03.

Flow Chart No – 03
Graphical Representation of the Term Evaluation



As the reflection of this Chart No – 05, Measurement, Assessment and Feedback are the major and essential elements of the Evaluation Process. Formative Assessment should be conducted time to time for identification purposes and arrange various special programmes for slow and fast learners. Evaluation is very important step in this mechanism because it enquires the whole teaching learning process and investigate that whether students achieved desired learning outcomes.

Conclusion

It is the responsibility of a productive and efficient teacher to ensure the proper and inclusive development of all his students and to make them capable so that they can contribute to the progress of the society by becoming productive citizens. To make the concept of 'Play, Learn and Grow Together' of inclusive education into reality, a teacher, institution, society and support services will have to work together. This mechanism will certainly encourage teachers to identify slow and fast learners, organize special programs for their betterment and use evaluation techniques and try to integrate these students into the mainstream.

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